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Head-up display device

Abstract

According to at least one aspect, the present disclosure provides a head-up display device comprising: a housing including a receiving space within; a picture generation unit (PGU) disposed within the housing, for projecting an image related to vehicle driving information; one or more reflection members for reflecting an image projected from the PGU; a fixing member formed to be fixed to a vehicle body; and one or more length adjustment members coupled to the fixing member, for movably supporting the housing.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application claims priority to and the benefit of Korean Patent Application No. 10-2021-0118428, filed on Sep. 6, 2021, the disclosure of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

1. Technical Field
- (2) The present disclosure relates to a head-up display device.
2. Discussion of Related Art
- (3) This section provides background information related to the present disclosure which is not necessarily prior art.
- (4) A head-up display (HUD) is a device that projects various information related to driving of a vehicle, such as current speed, navigation, and amount of fuel, onto a windshield so that the driver can see it. Using the head-up display, the driver is able to view information related to driving of the

vehicle and therefore look forward without having to refocus and shift attention often during driving.

(5) The head-up display may include a housing with a receiving space formed within, a light source for emitting light, a liquid crystal display (LCD) for projecting an image, a reflection member, a cover, and so on. The head-up display is installed under the windshield of the vehicle because of its features.

(6) An image displayed on the windshield of the vehicle is produced using components such as a light source, an LCD, and a reflection member. The image may be distorted due to the tolerance of each component, or the image may be displayed outside the driver's field of vision.

(7) Conventionally, the tolerances of the components are minimized in the manufacturing process, in order to prevent an image on a head-up display from being distorted or displayed outside the driver's field of vision. After the manufacturing process of the components, calibration equipment and software are used to correct a distorted image or change the position of an image.

(8) Minimizing the tolerances of components is inconvenient because tight tolerance control is required in the manufacturing process of the components. After the manufacturing process, it is not possible for a service center for maintenance and repair of the head-up display to correct a distorted image or change the position of an image.

(9) Correcting an image using calibration equipment and software is problematic in that the calibration equipment is expensive and special training is required to use the calibration equipment and software.

SUMMARY

(10) According to at least one aspect, the present disclosure provides a head-up display device comprising: a housing including a receiving space within; a picture generation unit (PGU) disposed within the housing, for projecting an image related to vehicle driving information; one or more reflection members for reflecting an image projected from the PGU; a fixing member formed to be fixed to a vehicle body; and one or more length adjustment members coupled to the fixing member, for movably supporting the housing.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is an assembled head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(2) FIG. 2 is an exploded perspective view of a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 3 is a plan view of a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 4 is a rear view of a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(5) FIG. 5 is a view showing an internal structure of a fixing member and a length adjustment member according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(6) FIG. 6 is a view showing a first operating state of a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(7) FIG. 7 is a view showing a second operating state of a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(8) FIG. 8 is a view showing a third operating state of a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(9) FIG. 9 is a view showing a fourth operating state of a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(10) A head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure allows avoiding the inconvenience of tight tolerance control and enables a service center or the like to correct a distorted image or change the position of an image, by installing one or more length adjustment members so that the housing is moved.

(11) A head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure is capable of correcting a distorted image or changing the position of an image using calibration equipment and software for this purpose, by installing one or more length adjustment members so that the housing is moved.

(12) The aspects of the present disclosure are not limited to the foregoing, and other aspects not mentioned herein will be able to be clearly understood by those skilled in the art from the following description.

(13) Hereinafter, some exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure will be described in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings. In the following description, like reference numerals preferably designate like elements, although the elements are shown in different drawings. Further, in the following description of some embodiments, a detailed description of known functions and configurations incorporated therein will be omitted for the purpose of clarity and for brevity.

(14) Additionally, various terms such as first, second, A, B, (a), (b), etc., are used solely to differentiate one component from the other but not to imply or suggest the substances, order, or sequence of the components. Throughout this specification, when a part 'includes' or 'comprises' a component, the part is meant to further include other components, not to exclude thereof unless specifically stated to the contrary. The terms such as 'unit,' 'module,' and the like refer to one or more units for processing at least one function or operation, which may be implemented by hardware, software, or a combination thereof.

(15) FIG. 1 is an assembled head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(16) FIG. 2 is an exploded perspective view of a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(17) FIG. 3 is a plan view of a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(18) FIG. 4 is a rear view of a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(19) FIG. 5 is a view showing an internal structure of a fixing member and a length adjustment member according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(20) Referring to FIGS. 1 to 5, a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure may include a housing **100**, a fixing member **200**, a length adjustment member **300**, a picture generation unit (PGU) **400**, a reflection member **500**, a heat sink **600**, a dust cover **700**, a screen **800**, and a printed circuit board (PCB) **900**.

(21) The housing **100** may include an upper case **110** and a lower case **120**.

(22) The upper case **110** may include a penetration part **111**, and the lower case **120** may include a fastening hole **121**.

(23) The fixing member **200** may include a support part **210**, a first insertion hole **220**, and a second insertion hole **230**.

(24) The length adjustment member **300** may include an aiming bolt **310**, a moving member **320**, and a joint **330**.

(25) The aiming bolt **310** may include a head part **311**, a body part **312**, and a first insertion part **313**.

(26) The moving member may include a first receptacle **321**, a connection part **322**, and a second insertion part **323**.

(27) The joint **330** may include a second receptacle **331** and a fastening part **332**.

(28) The reflection member **500** may include a first mirror **510** and a second mirror **520**.

(29) The housing **100** is a member with a receiving space formed within, and the PGU **400**, the reflection member **500**, the PCB **900**, etc. are disposed within the housing **100**. The housing **100** may include an upper case **110** and a lower case **120**. The penetration part **111** may be formed in at least part of the upper case **110**, and at least one fastening hole **121** may be formed in the lower case **120**.

(30) The penetration part **111** is a member that is formed in at least part of the upper case **110** to allow light to pass through. As the penetration part **111** is formed in the upper case **110**, an image related to vehicle driving information to be transferred using the PGU **400** and the reflection member **500** may be displayed on the windshield of the vehicle. The dust cover **700** may be installed over the penetration part **111**. The dust cover **700** prevents foreign matters such as dust from getting inside the housing **100**.

(31) The fastening hole **121** may be formed in a plural form at the front, rear, and side of the lower case **120**. With the fastening part **332** being inserted and extending into the fastening hole **121**, the lower case **120** and the length adjustment member **300** are coupled together. The housing **100** including the lower case **120** may be moved as the length of the length adjustment member **300** changes, thereby correcting a distorted image on the head-up display device. However, the fastening hole **121** is not necessarily formed in the lower case **120**, but may be formed in the lower case **110** depending on the purpose and use.

(32) The fixing member **200** is fixed to a vehicle body, and is coupled to the housing **100** and the length adjustment member **300**. The fixing member **200** may support the housing **100** in such a way that the housing **100** is moved at least one point by using the length adjustment member **300**, and may include a support part **210**, a first insertion hole **220**, and a second insertion hole **230**.

(33) The support part **210** is a member that supports the housing **100** and the length adjustment member **300**, and is formed in such a way as to be fixed to the vehicle body. The support part **210** may be formed in the shape of a plate so as to stably support the housing **100** and the length adjustment member **300**. The first insertion hole **220** and the second insertion hole **230** may be formed on both sides of the support part **210**, respectively.

(34) The first insertion hole **220** may be formed on one side of the support part **210** in the shape of a hollow cylinder. The aiming bolt **310** is inserted and extending into the first insertion hole **220**. One end of the first insertion hole **220** may be smaller in inner diameter than the diameter of the body part **312**, so as to keep the aiming bolt **310** from being moved into the first insertion hole **220** when it rotates.

(35) One end of the first insertion hole **220** is formed in the shape of a nozzle in which its inner diameter becomes gradually smaller. Since one end of the first insertion hole **220** is formed in the shape of a nozzle, the aiming bolt **310** is kept from being moved into the first insertion hole **220** when it rotates. However, one end of the first insertion hole **220** is not necessarily limited to the nozzle shape, but may have other shapes, including a shape in which a holder is installed to keep the aiming bolt **310** from being moved into the first insertion hole **220** when it rotates.

(36) The second insertion hole **230** may be formed on one side of the support part **210** in the shape of a square or rectangular cylinder. The first receptacle **321** of the moving member **320** is inserted and extending into the second insertion hole **230**. When the moving member **320** moves along with the rotation of the aiming bolt **310**, the second insertion hole **230** may guide the movement of the moving member **320**. The second insertion hole **230** may be equal in length to the first receptacle **321**. Since the second insertion hole **230** is equal in length to the first receptacle **321**, the moving member **320** may be prevented from being inserted too far into the second insertion hole **230**.

(37) The length adjustment member **300** is a member that is coupled to the fixing member **200** and movably supports the housing **100**. The housing **100** may be moved as the length of the length adjustment member **300** changes. The length adjustment member **300** may be provided in a plural form. Using a plurality of length adjustment members **300**, the housing **100** may be moved at

various angles, thereby correcting a distorted image on the head-up display device or changing the position of an image. The length adjustment member **300** may include an aiming bolt **310**, a moving member **320**, and a joint **330**.

(38) The aiming bolt **310** is installed in such a way as to pass through the first insertion hole **220** and second insertion hole **230** of the fixing member **200**, with at least part of it being inserted and extending into the moving member **320**. The aiming bolt **310** is supported by one end of the first insertion hole **220** so as to be kept from being moved into the first insertion hole **220** when it rotates. As the aiming bolt **310** rotates, the moving member **320** and the joint **330** may be moved, and as a result, the housing **100** may be moved. The aiming bolt **310** may be provided in a plural form, and may include a head part **311**, a body part **312**, and an insertion part **313**.

(39) The head part **311** is larger in diameter than the body part **312** and the first insertion part **313**. A groove may be formed in the head part **311** so that the aiming bolt **310** is rotated by using a tool such as a screwdriver.

(40) The body part **312** is a member that is formed with the head part **311** connected to it, and may be rotated by the head part **311**. One end of the body part **312** is formed in the shape of a nozzle in which its inner diameter becomes gradually smaller. The body part **312** is kept from being moved into the first insertion hole **220** as it is supported by one end of the first insertion hole **220**.

(41) The first insertion part **313** is a member that is formed with the body part **312** connected to it, and may be rotated by the head part **311** and the body part **312**. At least part of the first insertion part **313** is inserted and extending into the first receptacle **321** of the moving member **320**. As the first insertion part **313** is inserted and extending into the moving member **320** and rotates, the moving member **320** may be moved.

(42) The moving member **320** is a member that is formed to move along with the rotation of the aiming bolt **310**. The aiming bolt **310** is inserted and extending into one end of the moving member **320**, and the other end is inserted and extending into the joint **330**. At least part of the moving member **320** may be inserted and extending into the second insertion hole **230** of the fixing member **200**. The moving member **320** may be provided in a plural form, and may include a first receptacle **321**, a connection part **322**, and a second insertion part **323**.

(43) The first receptacle **321** is formed in the shape of a square cylinder, and may include a circular-shaped hollow. The first insertion part **313** is inserted and extending into the hollow of the first receptacle **321**. As the first insertion part **313** is inserted and extending into the first receptacle **321**, the moving member **320** may move along with the rotation of the aiming bolt **310**. The first receptacle **321** may be inserted and extending into the second insertion hole **230** of the fixing member **200**, and may be equal in length to the second insertion hole **230**. As the first receptacle **321** is inserted and extending into the second insertion hole **230**, the second insertion hole **230** may guide the movement of the moving member **320**.

(44) The connection part **322** is formed between the first receptacle **321** and the second insertion part **323**. The connection part **322** moves along with the first receptacle **321** and the second insertion part **323** as the aiming bolt **310** rotates. The connection part **322** is formed in the shape of a circular plate whose diameter is longer than the diagonal length of the second insertion hole **230**. Since the connection part **322** is formed between the first receptacle **321** and the second insertion part **323**, the moving member **320** may be prevented from being inserted too far into the second insertion hole **230**. However, the connection part **322** is not necessarily limited to the circular plate shape, but may have other shapes depending on the purpose and use.

(45) The second insertion part **323** is formed with the connection part **322** connected to it. The second insertion part **323** moves along with the first receptacle **321** and the connection part **322** as the aiming bolt **310** rotates. One end of the second insertion part **323** may be formed in the shape of a sphere. At least part of the second insertion part **323** is inserted and extending into the second receptacle **331** of the joint **330**. The second insertion part **323** and the second receptacle **331** may be coupled together in such a way as to cover and fix a sphere-shaped member formed on one end

of the second insertion part **323**.

(46) The joint **330** is a member that is formed to be connected to the moving member **320**. At least part of the moving member **320** is inserted and extending into one end of the joint **330**, and the other end is inserted and extending into the fastening hole **121** formed in the lower case **120**. As the aiming bolt **310** rotates, the moving member **320** and the joint **330** may be moved, and as a result, the housing **100** may be moved. The joint **330** may be provided in a plural form, and may include a second receptacle **331** and a fastening part **332**.

(47) The second receptacle **331** is a member that is formed in such a way that the second insertion part **323** of the moving member **320** is inserted in it, and moves along with the moving member **320** as the aiming bolt **310** rotates. The second receptacle **331** may be formed in such a way as to cover a sphere-shaped member formed on one end of the second insertion part **323**.

(48) The fastening part **332** is a member that is formed with the second receptacle **331** connected to it, and moves along with the second receptacle **331** as the moving member **320** moves. With the fastening part **332** being inserted and extending into the fastening hole **121** formed in the lower case **120**, the housing **100** and the length adjustment member **300** are coupled together. At least part of the fastening part **332** may be curved so that the fastening part **332** is inserted and fixed into the fastening hole **121**. Since the housing **100** and the length adjustment member **300** are coupled together using the fastening part **332** and the fastening hole **121**, the housing **100** may be moved as the length of the length adjustment member **300** changes.

(49) The PGU **400** is a member that is formed to project an image related to vehicle driving information. The PGU **400** may include a light source, a diffuser, and a liquid crystal display (LCD). The PGU **400** is disposed within the housing **100**.

(50) The reflection member **500** is a member that is formed to reflect an image projected from the PGU **400**, and may be provided in a plural form. The reflection member **500** may include a first mirror **510** and a second mirror **520**.

(51) The first mirror **510** is a member that reflects an image projected from the PGU **400** transfers it to the second mirror **520**. The first mirror **510** is disposed within the housing **100**.

(52) The second mirror **520** is a member that reflects an image transferred from the first mirror **510** and displays it on the windshield of the vehicle. The second mirror **520** is disposed within the housing **100**.

(53) The heat sink **600** is a member that is formed to release heat generated from the light source or the like of the PGU **400**. The heat sink **600** may include a plurality of fins to promote active heat exchange with the outside. Since heat is released from the housing **100** using the heat sink **600**, the lifetime of each component of the head-up display device may be lengthened.

(54) The dust cover **700** is a member for preventing foreign matters such as dust from getting into the housing **100**, and may be installed on the penetration part **111** of the upper case **110**. The dust cover **700** may be formed to allow light to pass through, and an image related to vehicle driving information reflected off the reflection member **500** may be displayed on the windshield of the vehicle.

(55) FIG. **6** is a view showing a first operating state of a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(56) FIG. **7** is a view showing a second operating state of a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(57) FIG. **8** is a view showing a third operating state of a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(58) FIG. **9** is a view showing a fourth operating state of a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(59) Referring to FIGS. **6** to **9**, the operating principles and effects of a head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure will be described in detail.

(60) The length adjustment member **300** is coupled to the fixing member **200** and movably

supports the housing **100**. A plurality of length adjustment members **300** may be installed on both sides and the rear of the housing **100** and support the housing **100** in such a way that the housing **100** is allowed to perform three-point movement. The length adjustment member **300** includes an aiming bolt **310**, a moving member **320**, and a joint **330**. A first insertion part **313** of the aiming bolt **310** is inserted and extending into the moving member **320**, and a second insertion part **323** of the moving member **320** is inserted and extending into the joint **330**. The moving member **320** may move along with the rotation of the aiming bolt **310**. As the moving member **320** moves, the joint **330** moves too. As a result, the entire length of the length adjustment member **300** may be extended, and the housing **100** coupled to the length adjustment member **300** may be moved.

(61) Referring to FIG. **6**, the lengths of the plurality of length adjustment members **300** installed on both sides and the rear of the housing **100** may change equally. As the lengths of the plurality of length adjustment members **300** installed on both sides and the rear of the housing **100** change equally, the housing **100** may be moved up and down while being maintained in a horizontal position. The magnification of an image related to vehicle driving information may be adjusted, and the position of an image displayed on the windshield may be changed.

(62) Referring to FIG. **7**, the length of the length adjustment member **300** installed on the rear of the housing **100** may change. As the length of the length adjustment member **300** installed on the rear of the housing **100** changes, a back portion of the housing **100** may be moved up and down. A trapezoidal image whose top and bottom sides are parallel may be corrected into a rectangular image.

(63) Referring to FIG. **8**, the lengths of the length adjustment members **300** installed on both sides of the housing **100** may change. As the lengths of the length adjustment members **300** installed on both sides of the housing **100** change, side portions of the housing **100** may be moved up and down. A trapezoidal image whose left and right sides are parallel may be corrected into a rectangular image.

(64) Referring to FIG. **9**, the lengths of the plurality of length adjustment members **300** installed on both sides and the rear of the housing **100** may change differently. As the lengths of the plurality of length adjustment members **300** installed on both sides and the rear of the housing **100** change differently, the housing **100** may be moved three points. A parallelogram image or the like may be corrected, or the position of an image may be changed.

(65) A head-up display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure is capable of correcting a distorted image or changing the position of an image by moving the housing **100** using a plurality of length adjustment members **300**. This head-up display device allows avoiding the inconvenience of tight tolerance control in the manufacturing process of components, and enables image correction later at a service center. Also, this head-up display makes it possible to correct a distorted image and change the position of an image in a mechanical manner using the length adjustment members **300**, without using calibration equipment and software which are expensive and require training.

(66) According to an embodiment, a head-up display device has the effects of avoiding the inconvenience of tight tolerance control and enabling a service center or the like to correct a distorted image or change the position of an image, by installing one or more length adjustment members so that the housing is moved.

(67) According to an embodiment, a head-up display device has the effect of correcting a distorted image or changing the position of an image using calibration equipment and software for this purpose, by installing one or more length adjustment member so that the housing is moved.

Claims

1. A head-up display device comprising: a housing having a receiving space; a picture generation unit (PGU) disposed at the receiving space of the housing and configured to project an image; one

- or more reflection members configured to reflect the image projected from the PGU; a fixing member coupled to a vehicle body; and one or more length adjustment members coupled to the fixing member and configured to movably support the housing, wherein each of the one or more length adjustment members includes at least one of an aiming bolt, a moving member, and a joint.
2. The head-up display device of claim 1, further comprising a penetration part at least partially disposed at the receiving space of the housing and configured to allow light to pass therethrough.
 3. The head-up display device of claim 2, further comprising a dust cover disposed over the penetration part and configured to prevent foreign matter from entering into the receiving space of the housing.
 4. The head-up display device of claim 1, wherein the fixing member has one or more insertion holes.
 5. The head-up display device of claim 4, wherein the one or more insertion holes have a circular or square shape.
 6. The head-up display device of claim 1, wherein the one or more length adjustment members is configured to support the housing in such a way that the housing is allowed to perform three-point movement.
 7. The head-up display device of claim 1, wherein: at least part of the aiming bolt extends into the moving member, the moving member at least partially extend into the joint, and the moving member and the joint are configured to move along with a rotation of the aiming bolt.
 8. The head-up display device of claim 1, wherein the aiming bolt includes a head part, a body part, and a first insertion part.
 9. The head-up display device of claim 8, wherein one end of the body part has a nozzle shape.
 10. The head-up display device of claim 8, wherein the first insertion part at least partially extends into the moving member.
 11. The head-up display device of claim 1, wherein the moving member includes at least one of a first receptacle, a connection part, and a second insertion part.
 12. The head-up display device of claim 11, wherein the first receptacle has a square cylinder shape.
 13. The head-up display device of claim 11, wherein one end of the second insertion part has a spherical shape.
 14. The head-up display device of claim 11, wherein the second insertion part at least partially extends into the joint.
 15. The head-up display device of claim 1, wherein the joint includes a second receptacle and a fastening part.
 16. The head-up display device of claim 15, wherein the housing has a fastening hole, and the fastening part extends into the fastening hole.
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